

Pausanias' Description of Greece

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Chapter: Book 1

Chapter 1

Sections 1, 2, 3, 4, 5

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1.1.1 BOOK 1

On the Greek mainland facing the [Cyclades](#) Islands and the [Aegean Sea](#) the [Sunium](#) promontory stands out from the [Attic](#) land. When you have rounded the promontory you see a harbor and a [temple](#) to [Athena Sounias](#) on the peak of the promontory. Farther on is [Laurium](#), where once the [Athenians](#) had silver mines, and a small uninhabited island called the [Island of Patroclus](#). For a fortification was built on it and a palisade constructed by [Patroclus](#), who was admiral in command of the [Egyptian](#) men-of-war sent by [Ptolemy](#), son of [Ptolemy](#), son of [Lagus](#), to help the [Athenians](#), when [Antigonos](#), son of [Demetrius](#), was ravaging their country, which he had invaded with an army, and at the same time was blockading them by sea with a fleet.

1.1.2 The [Peiraeus](#) was a deme from early times, though it was not a port before [Themistocles](#) became an archon of the [Athenians](#). Their port was [Phalerum](#), for at this place the sea comes nearest to [Athens](#), and from here men say that [Menestheus](#) set sail with his fleet for [Troy](#), and before him [Theseus](#), when he went to give satisfaction to [Minos](#) for the death of [Androgeos](#). But when [Themistocles](#) became archon [493 BCE], since he thought that the [Peiraeus](#) was more conveniently situated for mariners, and had three harbors as against one at [Phalerum](#), he made it the [Athenian](#) port. Even up to my time there were [shipsheds](#) there, and near the largest [harbor](#) is the grave of [Themistocles](#). For it is said that the [Athenians](#) repented of their treatment of [Themistocles](#), and that his relations took up his bones and brought them from [Magnesia](#). And the children of [Themistocles](#) certainly returned and set up in the [Parthenon](#) a painting, on which is a portrait of [Themistocles](#).

1.1.3 The most noteworthy sight in the [Peiraeus](#) is a precinct of [Athena](#) and [Zeus](#). Both their images are of bronze; [Zeus](#) holds a staff and a [Victory](#), [Athena](#) a spear. Here is a portrait of [Leosthenes](#) and of his sons, painted by [Arcesilaus](#). This [Leosthenes](#) at the head of the [Athenians](#) and the united Greeks defeated the [Macedonians](#) in [Boeotia](#) and again outside [Thermopylae](#) forced them into [Lamia](#) over against [Oeta](#), and shut them up there. The portrait is in the [Long Stoa](#), where stands an agora for those living near the sea — those farther away from the harbor have another — but behind the stoa near the sea stand a [Zeus](#) and a [Demos](#), the work of [Leochares](#). And by the sea [Conon](#) built a sanctuary of [Aphrodite](#), after he had crushed the [Lacedemonian](#) triremes off [Cnidus](#) in the [Carian](#) peninsula. For the [Cnidians](#) hold [Aphrodite](#) in very great honor, and they have sanctuaries of the goddess; the oldest is to her as [Doritis](#) (Bountiful), the next in age as [Acraea](#) (Of the Height/Promontory), while the newest is to the [Aphrodite](#) called [Cnidian](#) by men generally, but [Euploia](#) (Fair Voyage) by the [Cnidians](#) themselves.

1.1.4 The [Athenians](#) have also another harbor, at [Munychia](#), with a temple of [Munychian Artemis](#), and yet another at [Phalerum](#), as I have already stated, and near it is a sanctuary of [Demeter](#). Here there is also a temple of [Athena Sciras](#), and one of [Zeus](#) some distance away, and altars of the gods named [Unknown](#), and of heroes, and of the children of [Theseus](#) and [Phalerus](#); for this [Phalerus](#) is said by the [Athenians](#) to have sailed with [Jason](#) to [Colchis](#). There is also an altar of [Androgeos](#), son of [Minos](#), though it is called that of Heros; those, however, who pay special attention to the study of their country's antiquities know that it belongs to [Androgeos](#).

1.1.5 Twenty stades away is the [Colias promontory](#); onto it, when the [Persian](#) fleet was destroyed, the wrecks were carried down by the waves. There is here an image of the [Coliad Aphrodite](#), with the goddesses [Genetyllides](#) (Goddesses of Birth), as they are called. And I am of opinion that the goddesses of the [Phocaeans](#) in [Ionia](#), whom they call Gennaides, are the same as those at [Colias](#). On the way from [Phalerum](#) to [Athens](#) there is a temple of [Hera](#) with neither doors nor roof. Men say that [Mardonius](#), son of [Gobryas](#), burnt it. But the image there today is, as report goes, the work of [Alcamenes](#). So that this, at any rate, cannot have been damaged by the [Persians](#).

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